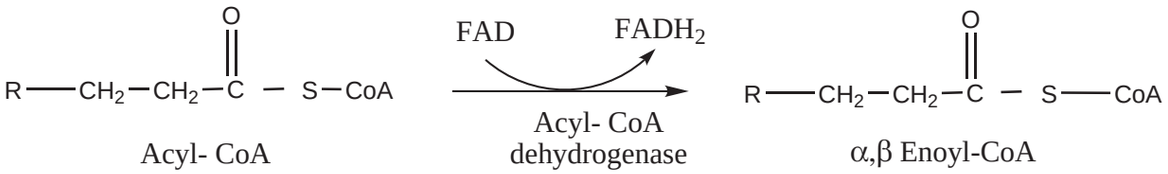
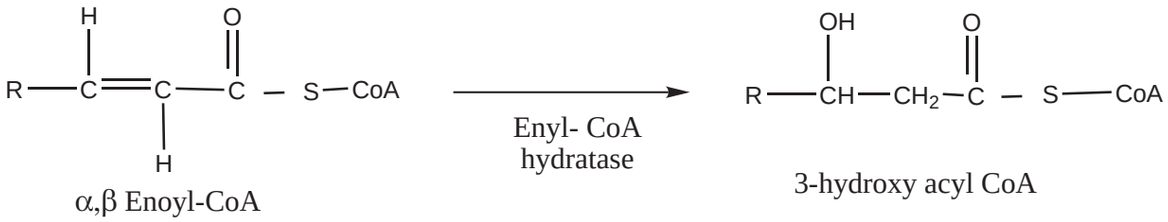
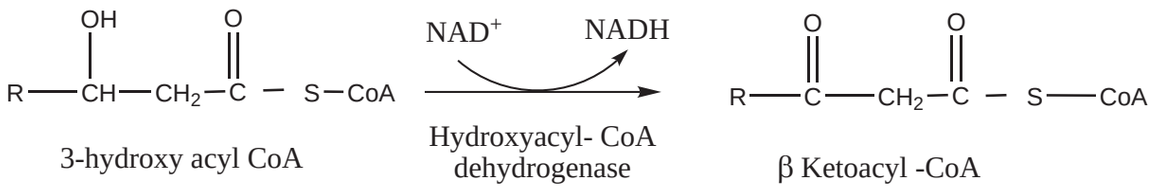
Oxidation



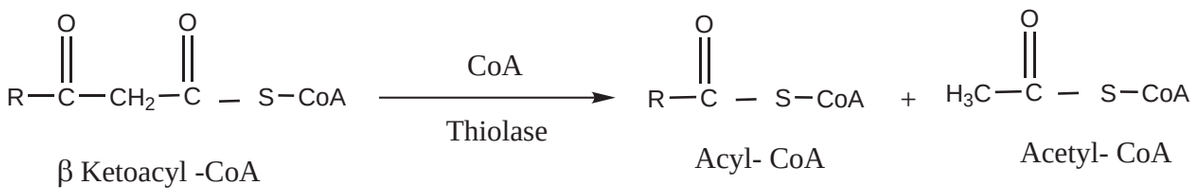
Hydrolysis



Oxidation



Thiolysis



Fatty acids are oxidized by most of the tissues in the body. However, brain, erythrocytes and adrenal medulla cannot utilize fatty acids for energy requirement.

5.4 CHOLESTEROL

Cholesterol is widely distributed in all cells and is a major component of the cell membrane and lipoproteins. Cholesterol is found exclusively in animals; hence it is often called as animal sterol. The total body content of cholesterol in an adult man weighing 70 kg is about 140 g i.e., around 2g/ kg body weight. Cholesterol is amphipathic in nature, since it possesses both hydrophilic and hydrophobic regions in the structure.

Cholesterol is a C_{27} alcohol with molecular formula $C_{27}H_{46}O$. It has a structure consisting of four fused hydrocarbon rings forming the bulky steroid structure. There is a

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